

Supplier onboarding checklist

BUY-CHK-003. Issued by Buying, 1 February 2026.

Every new supplier goes through this list before a first purchase order is raised. It exists because two suppliers in the last five years shipped against terms nobody had read, and both times the argument was about something on this page.

Commercial

Agree cost prices in writing, in pounds sterling, with the currency stated even when it is obvious. Agree payment terms, minimum order value, and whether carriage is included above a threshold. Agree what happens to a price when the underlying currency moves, because it will.

Ask for the returns and warranty position in writing before the first order: how long, what is excluded, who pays the carriage, and whether a faulty part is credited or replaced. A supplier who will not put this in writing is telling you something.

Product data

We need, for every line: the manufacturer's part number, a description, the packed weight in grams, the packed dimensions, the barcode, and the country of origin. The weight is the one that gets forgotten and it is the one that prices delivery, so a line without a weight does not go live.

Photographs at 2000 pixels on the long edge, on white, with no watermark. Line drawings where the part has a fit dimension that matters.

Technical

Fit standards, torque figures, and any approved-use list — the hookless rim and tyre approval lists are the current example, and the workshop needs them before the first unit is sold, not after the first complaint.

Spares availability, stated as a number of years, and the part numbers of the spares. A component we cannot get bearings for in three years is a component we should not range.

Compliance and logistics

Confirm whether any line is classed as dangerous goods. Sealant, aerosols and pressurised cartridges are, and they change what we can ship and where.

Confirm lead times honestly and record them. A lead time we have written down is a lead time we can quote to a customer; a lead time somebody remembers from a phone call is not.

Sign-off

Buying signs off the commercial section, the workshop manager signs off the technical section, and Fulfilment signs off product data and logistics. All three, before the first purchase order. There is no fast track and asking for one is how both of the arguments above started.